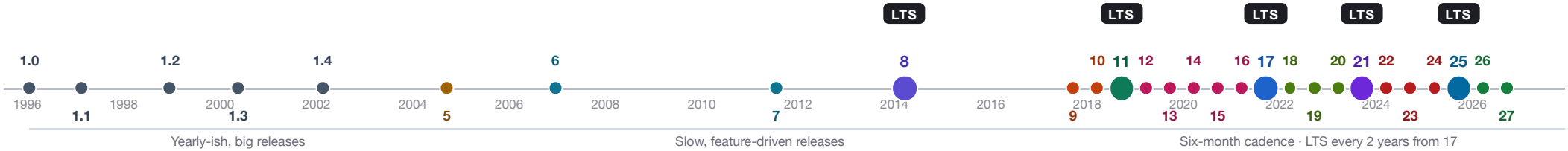
JAVA, VERSION BY VERSION · RELEASE TIMELINE

Thirty years of Java · 28 releases, 5 long-term-support lines

Latest release: Java 27 (Sep 2026). Current LTS: Java 25 (Sep 2025). Each card below is one chapter of the guide; colours match throughout.

LTS long-term support (big dot) • small dot: feature release, supported six months



1 Java 1.0–1.4

The foundations

Java 1.0 Jan 1996
Object model · JVM and GC · Threads · Applets

Java 1.1 Feb 1997
Inner classes · Reflection · JDBC · Serialization

Java 1.2 Dec 1998
Collections · Swing · "Java 2"

Java 1.3 May 2000
HotSpot by default · Dynamic proxies · JNDI

Java 1.4 Feb 2002
assert · Regex · NIO · Logging

2 Java 5

The language grows up

Java 5 Sep 2004
Generics · Enums and annotations · java.util.concurrent · Autoboxing, for-each

3 Java 6–7

Polish and plumbing

Java 6 Dec 2006
Scripting API · Compiler API · NavigableMap · JDBC 4.0

Java 7 Jul 2011
try-with-resources · Diamond · NIO.2 · Fork/Join · invokedynamic

4 Java 8

The functional turn

Java 8 LTS Mar 2014
Lambdas · Streams · java.time · Optional · CompletableFuture

5 Java 9–10

Modules and the new cadence

Java 9 Sep 2017
Modules · JShell · List.of · G1 default · Flow API

Java 10 Mar 2018
var · AppCDS · Container awareness · Six-month cadence

6 Java 11

The new baseline

Java 11 LTS Sep 2018
HTTP Client · java Hello.java · String.strip/lines · ZGC (experimental) · Java EE removed

7 Java 12–16

Modern syntax arrives

Java 12 Mar 2019
Switch expressions (preview) · Collectors.teeing · Shenandoah (experimental)

Java 13 Sep 2019
Text blocks (preview) · Switch expressions (2nd preview) · Socket API reimplemented

Java 14 Mar 2020
Switch expressions · Records (preview) · Helpful NPEs · jpackage (incubator)

Java 15 Sep 2020
Text blocks · Sealed classes (preview) · ZGC & Shenandoah production · Hidden classes

Java 16 Mar 2021
Records · Pattern matching instanceof · Stream.toList · Strong encapsulation

8 Java 17

Sealed and settled

Java 17 LTS Sep 2021
Sealed classes · Switch patterns (preview) · Strong encapsulation · RandomGenerator

9 Java 18–20

Loom and Panama in preview

Java 18 Mar 2022
UTF-8 by default · jwebserver · @snippet

Java 19 Sep 2022
Virtual threads (preview) · Record patterns (preview) · FFM (preview)

Java 20 Mar 2023
Scoped values (incubator) · Structured concurrency · Patterns, 2nd/4th preview

10 Java 21

Virtual threads and patterns

Java 21 LTS Sep 2023
Virtual threads · Record patterns · Switch patterns · Sequenced collections

11 Java 22–24

Gatherers, FFM and simpler starts

Java 22 Mar 2024
FFM API final · Unnamed variables · Multi-file launch · Gatherers preview

Java 23 Sep 2024
Markdown Javadoc · Generational ZGC default · Primitive patterns preview · String templates dropped

Java 24 Mar 2025
Stream gatherers · Class-File API · AOT class loading · Post-quantum crypto

12 Java 25

The new LTS

Java 25 LTS Sep 2025
Scoped values · Compact source files · Module imports · AOT cache · Compact headers

13 Java 26–27

Faster by default, ready for post-quantum

Java 26 Mar 2026
HTTP/3 · Final-field warnings · AOT cache with any GC · Applet API removed

Java 27 Sep 2026
G1 everywhere · Compact headers by default · Post-quantum TLS · JFR redaction

Dates are general-availability months from openjdk.org. "Top features" are the chapter's starred cards.